

KukuConnect - Domain, Vercel and DNS Guide

Farm Management System - setup guide (no new domain required)

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1. Your current setup (this is normal)

You own kukuconnect.co.ke. The marketing website is hosted on Vercel. DNS (name servers / records) is managed somewhere else - for example your registrar, Cloudflare, or a host control panel.

You do NOT need to buy another domain. You do NOT need to move all DNS into Vercel unless you want to.

2. Recommended architecture

Keep the marketing site on the main domain. Put this Farm Management app on a free subdomain:

- www.kukuconnect.co.ke = Marketing site (current Vercel project)

- app.kukuconnect.co.ke = Farm Management System (this Next.js project)

Farmers order at: <https://app.kukuconnect.co.ke/order>

Staff login at: <https://app.kukuconnect.co.ke/login>

On the marketing site, add buttons that link to those URLs (Order chicks / Staff).

3. Deploy the farm app on Vercel

A. Push this farm-management repository to GitHub (if not already).

B. In Vercel: Add New Project - Import the farm-management repository.

C. Framework: Next.js (auto-detected). Deploy once so the project has a .vercel.app URL.

D. Project - Settings - Environment Variables. Set at least:

```
NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL=https://app.kukuconnect.co.ke
NEXT_PUBLIC_MPESA_TILL=your_real_till_or_paybill
NEXT_PUBLIC_STAFF_PHONE=2547XXXXXXX
NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL=... (only if using Supabase)
NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY=... (only if using Supabase)
```

Redeploy after saving env vars so they apply to production.

4. Add domain in Vercel

1. Open the Farm Management project in Vercel.

2. Go to Settings - Domains (or Project - Domains).

3. Add domain: app.kukuconnect.co.ke

4. Vercel will show the DNS record to create. Usually it is:

```
Type: CNAME
Name: app
Value: cname.vercel-dns.com
```

If Vercel shows a different target value, copy exactly what Vercel displays.

5. Leave www.kukuconnect.co.ke on the marketing project. Do not remove it unless you intend to replace the whole public website.

5. Create the DNS record (where DNS is handled)

Log into wherever DNS is managed today (not necessarily Vercel):

- Cloudflare: DNS - Records - Add record

- Namecheap: Advanced DNS - Add new record

- GoDaddy / Truehost / other: DNS management or Zone editor

Add this record:

CNAME | Host: app | Points to: cname.vercel-dns.com | TTL: Auto

Notes:

- Do not put https:// in the CNAME value.
- Host is often just "app" (not the full domain name).
- Cloudflare: if SSL stays pending, set the record to DNS only (grey cloud), not proxied.

Wait 5 to 60 minutes for DNS to propagate (sometimes up to a few hours).

6. SSL certificate

Vercel issues HTTPS automatically after DNS is correct. In Domains, status should become Valid or Active. Then open <https://app.kukuconnect.co.ke> in your browser.

7. Supabase (only if you use cloud login)

In Supabase - Authentication - URL configuration:

- Site URL: <https://app.kukuconnect.co.ke>
- Redirect URLs: https://app.kukuconnect.co.ke/**

If not already done, run SQL in Supabase: schema.sql, orders.sql, and optional sales_receipt_fields.sql and brooder.sql.

8. Smoke test after go-live

- Open <https://app.kukuconnect.co.ke> - dashboard loads
- Open /order - place a test farmer order
- Staff: confirm paid, check stock, print receipt
- Marketing site button opens the correct app URL

9. What you do NOT need

- A second domain purchase
- Moving nameservers fully to Vercel (optional only)
- Changing how the www marketing site is hosted

10. Troubleshooting

Domain stuck Invalid in Vercel: recheck CNAME name and value; wait for propagation; check dnschecker.org for app.kukuconnect.co.ke.

SSL / certificate error: wait for Vercel cert; on Cloudflare use DNS-only for the app CNAME.

App works on *.vercel.app but not custom domain: domain is on the wrong Vercel project, or env vars not redeployed.

Supabase login fails: Site URL and redirect URLs must match <https://app.kukuconnect.co.ke> exactly.

11. Quick reference

Marketing: <https://www.kukuconnect.co.ke>

Farm app: <https://app.kukuconnect.co.ke>

Orders: <https://app.kukuconnect.co.ke/order>

Staff: <https://app.kukuconnect.co.ke/login>

DNS: CNAME app -> cname.vercel-dns.com

Support: kukuconnect@outlook.com

This guide finishes the domain and DNS workstream for the Farm Management System. You can stop here and build other products; the app remains ready to deploy anytime with the steps above.